

The Professional Individual

Science

May, 2026



**SE
TU**

Ollscoil
Teicneolaíochta
an Oirdheiscirt

South East
Technological
University

The Professional Individual (A36041)

Short Title: The Professional Individual
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Placement and Projects
Author KGRENNAN
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module seeks to provide learners with practical skills to enable them to function effectively as an individual in a work context.

Programmes

PROF-0040	BSc (Hons) in Food Science and Innovation (WD_SFSIN_B)	2 / 4 / M
PROF-0040	BSc in Food Science with Business (WD_SFDSC_D)	2 / 4 / M
PROF-0040	BSc in Molecular Biology with Biopharmaceutical Science (WD_SMBIO_D)	3 / 6 / M
PROF-0040	BSc in Pharmaceutical Science (WD_SPHSC_D)	3 / 6 / M

Indicative Content

- Emotional intelligence and self awareness: definition of emotional intelligence and self awareness; distinguishing IQ from EQ; influences on development of self; the modern work context; the personal demands on the modern manager; importance of emotional intelligence and self awareness for work place success; developing improved emotional intelligence and self awareness
- Stress management: understanding stress and it's sources; organisational and individual costs of stress; identifying personal stressors; coping strategies for stress management - problem and emotion focussed; positive perspectives on stress
- Impression management and business etiquette: face-work and politeness, regulating information; barriers to making the intended impression; negotiating social transitions; work-based impression management; ethical issues in impression management
- Interview skills: picking the right job; staying motivated in your job search; preparation for the interview; the interview itself; follow up in success and failure
- Creative decision making and planning: establishing criteria for participative decision making; promoting creative thinking in organisations; communicating a vision; personal and organisational goal setting; evaluating and monitoring goals
- Preparation for work placement: CV development; industry profiling; understanding key skills and requirements; presentation of professional self

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Express their potential strengths as a business professional.
2. Employ reflective thought to adapt behaviour to context.
3. Construct an appropriate personal career development plan and professional profile, to include a skills needs analysis and CV.
4. Examine their transferable skills for integration and progression in the workplace.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Role play.
- Case studies.
- Student centred discussion and research.
- Self-assessment tests.
- Group work.
- Lectures.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>Reflective Journal</i>	60%	2,4
<i>Portfolio</i>	40%	1,3

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Unable to present self as a professional through their written work, no reflection.

40%-49%: Able to present knowledge of self as a professional through their written work, Reflections are descriptive.

50%-59%: Understands professional practice and can apply this in relation to self- evidenced through their written and presented work.

60%-69%: Presented work shows evidence of analysis regarding their professional persona; in the structure, content and format of their written work.

70%-100%: Excellent presented work; illustrates the evaluation of self as a professional and evaluation of professional practice through presented materials.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Practical	12	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- Feldman, S.R. *Power Learning - Strategies for Success in College and Life*. 6th ed. USA: McGraw Hill Higher Education, 2013.

Supplementary Material

- Caproni, P. *Management Skills for Everyday Life: The Practical Coach*. 3rd ed. USA: Prentice Hall, 2011.
- Robbins, S.P. and P.L. Hunsaker. *Training in Interpersonal Skills*. 6th ed. USA: Pearson Education, 2012.

Requested Resources

- Lecture Room: Loose Seated

- COMPUTER LAB: Multimedia Lab